

SKOAR!

FIFA 13

The Undisputed King

Jayesh "Big Daddy" Shinde
feedback@skoar.com

The mechanics of the game haven't deviated much from FIFA 12 to FIFA 13 – the look and feel of the menus, cut scene animations, background atmosphere, physics, etc. But having said that, FIFA 13 admirably builds on the foundations of FIFA 12 by heightening the sense of realism experienced within the game. You can play real-life matches that reflect the form and shape of a team at any given day – you can't pick injured players, team morale is reflective of league position, etc. – and the feature should be a great hit among fantasy football fans.

Prime among new features added to FIFA 13 is the skill games you have to take part in before kicking-off a game -- in FIFA 12 you had to run with the ball on the training ground which would transform into a packed arena. In FIFA 13 you play the skill games before kick-off, randomized to help you focus before a game. It's addictive and a great way of fine tuning technical skills, too. The in-game commentary continues to be brilliant with the addition of Geoff Shreeves and Alan McInally for updates from other live games and players injured during the game, respectively. This interplay between the commentators works seamlessly and is another nod towards FIFA 13's mission towards improved realism in the game.

FIFA 13 is the first game in EA's football franchise to support motion controllers. But



controlling and playing FIFA 13 through the Move motion controller isn't as intuitive or natural as playing a round of golf in Tiger Woods PGA Tour 13 or swinging a racquet in Grand Slam Tennis 2. Motion controller support is clunky on FIFA 13 and it's a work-in-progress for EA, something to focus on and fix in the next installment of the game.

You won't notice anything drastically different between FIFA 12 and FIFA 13's gameplay, other than a few subtleties in the latest version of the game. Player physics is fine tuned to further enhance depth and immersion in the game – collisions are much more natural, the ball's momentum matters while receiving a pass, the player's position plays a vital role, dribbling is even finer and more precise than before, and that's just a few noteworthy improvements. First Touch Control is the latest addition to the game, after the previous installments focused on dribbling and defensive aspects of the game.

FIFA 13 continues the encouraging gameplay mechanic tweaks introduced in FIFA 12 by making the game a little less predictive, and for all the right reasons. Sure it's still easy to score a goal and

yes the goalie could be more manoeuvrable but overall FIFA 13's gameplay is very good, we have no complaints. And watching a game unfold on the screen isn't far removed from the real deal. FIFA 13 successfully delivers a first class gaming experience, where one really feels that it's far more than just a football simulator. *

Verdict

FIFA 13 builds on the good work started by EA with FIFA 12, making the football simulator experience better than ever. A few new features really help the game attain new heights in mimicking realism, making this a bright new chapter in EA's celebrated football franchise.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** EA Canada
- » **Publisher:** EA Sports
- » **Genre:** Sports, Simulation
- » **Platforms:** Windows, Xbox 360, PS3, PS2, etc
- » **Price:** PC: ₹2,999 on PS3 and Xbox 360; ₹1,499 for PC

